

CARIBBEAN EARNER SERIES



GHOST KITCHEN BLUEPRINT

RENT A COMMERCIAL KITCHEN.
BUILD A CARIBBEAN FOOD BUSINESS.
DELIVER ANYWHERE.

REAL SKILLS. REAL INCOME. NO HYPE.



CaribStream.io

Ghost Kitchen Blueprint

Rent a Commercial Kitchen. Build a Caribbean Food Business. Deliver Anywhere.

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Second brand, additional kitchen time, and catering that multiplies revenue

INCOME BENCHMARKS

\$2,500+/month net at 20 orders/day · platform orders fund direct channel growth · Caribbean food commands premium pricing · no lease, no build-out, no restaurant overhead

The Ghost Kitchen Model — What It Is and What It Pays

Rent kitchen time. Build a Caribbean food brand. Deliver anywhere.

A ghost kitchen is a food business that operates entirely through delivery — no dining room, no storefront, no restaurant lease. You rent time in a licensed commercial kitchen, prepare your food, and fulfill orders through DoorDash, Uber Eats, and your own direct ordering page. The overhead is a fraction of a traditional restaurant. The profit margin is 2–3 times higher. And you serve your Caribbean community with the food they actually want.

\$2,500+

Monthly net margin at 20 orders/day · no lease · no build-out · no dining room staff ·
Caribbean food commands premium pricing in diaspora cities

Why Caribbean Food Is Perfect for This Model

Caribbean food in diaspora cities is chronically underrepresented on delivery platforms. The jerk chicken restaurant in Brooklyn has a 45-minute wait on Friday nights and cannot meet demand. The Trinidadian doubles cart downtown closes at 3pm. The Guyanese pepperpot that Caribbean families grew up eating is not available for delivery at all. Your ghost kitchen fills a real gap in a real market with food that your community has been waiting for.

What you need to start

A food handler's certification. Access to a licensed commercial kitchen. A DoorDash and Uber Eats merchant account. A menu of 5–8 Caribbean dishes that travel well. A name and a logo. Total investment: \$500–\$1,500. First weekend of orders pays it back.

What you do not need

A restaurant lease (\$3,000–\$8,000/month). A build-out (\$50,000–\$200,000). A dining room staff. A liquor license. Front-of-house management. Ghost kitchens eliminate every traditional restaurant cost center.

CARIBBEAN EARNER PRINCIPLE

Jamaica is one of the world's largest producers of ackee — the national fruit — and the birthplace of jerk seasoning and some of the most influential food culture in the world. Caribbean food carries cultural weight that no generic ghost kitchen concept can replicate. When you serve your community's food, you are selling home.

Finding and Renting Your Commercial Kitchen

Churches, shared kitchens, and restaurant off-hours — three ways to get started.

You cannot legally operate a food business from a home kitchen in any US state. You need a licensed commercial kitchen. The good news: commercial kitchen access is far more available and affordable than most people realize. Three channels give you professional kitchen access at a cost that keeps your margins intact.

1

Caribbean Churches — Your Natural First Partner

Caribbean churches with commercial kitchens sit unused on weekdays. Approach the pastor or facilities manager with a simple proposal: rent the kitchen Tuesday through Thursday for \$75–\$150 per day. You cook, you clean, you leave the space better than you found it. The church gets steady weekly rental income. You get a licensed commercial kitchen in your own community for \$225–\$450/week.

2

Shared Commercial Kitchens — The Professional Option

Shared commercial kitchens (commissary kitchens) rent by the hour or by the month. Hourly rates: \$15–\$35/hour. Monthly packages: \$300–\$800/month for 40–80 hours of kitchen time. Search 'commissary kitchen [your city]' or use Kitch.en to find shared kitchen space near you. Shared kitchens include licensed equipment, storage space, and NSF certification — everything you need for health department compliance.

3

Restaurant Off-Hours Rental

Restaurants that close at 2pm or are dark on Mondays need revenue from their idle kitchen. Approach Caribbean restaurant owners about renting their kitchen on their off days or after hours. You pay \$100–\$200 for a 4–6 hour session. The restaurant owner earns from an asset that was generating nothing. This is the arrangement many Caribbean ghost kitchen operators use to start.

4

Health Department Certification

Before your first order, verify your kitchen rental location has a current health department certificate posted. Obtain your food handler's certification (ServSafe or state equivalent — \$15–\$40, available online). Register your ghost kitchen business with your city or county health department — required in most jurisdictions for delivery food businesses. Cost: \$50–\$200 in most cities.

KITCHEN COST BREAKDOWN

Church kitchen rental (3 days/week): \$300–\$450/week · Shared commissary monthly: \$300–\$800/month · Restaurant off-hours session: \$100–\$200/session. Your kitchen cost should not exceed 15–20% of your weekly food revenue. At 20 orders/day averaging \$22/order: \$440/day revenue. Kitchen cost at 15%: \$66/day. Three days per week: \$198/week. Well within budget.

Your Menu, Your Platforms, and Your Direct Channel

A menu that photographs well, travels well, and sells on repeat.

Start with 5–8 dishes maximum. Too many options slow down your kitchen and increase food waste. Lead with your strongest 2–3 dishes — the ones you cook best and that photograph beautifully. For a Caribbean ghost kitchen the core menu almost designs itself: the dishes your community has been looking for on delivery apps and has never found.

1

Menu Design — What Travels Well

Jerk chicken with rice and peas travels perfectly in a sealed container. Curry goat holds its sauce and flavor through a 30-minute delivery window. Oxtail is a premium-priced item that commands \$22–\$28 per order and photographs beautifully with the sauce glistening over white rice. Fried plantains hold texture for 20 minutes. Doubles and roti are compact and travel cleanly. Avoid dishes with delicate textures that collapse in transit.

2

Platform Setup — DoorDash and Uber Eats

Register your ghost kitchen on DoorDash Merchant Portal and Uber Eats Restaurant Manager. Professional food photography is your most important marketing investment — hire a food photographer for \$150–\$300 for your first shoot, or use natural light and a smartphone with a ring light (\$30) and shoot every dish yourself. Platform commission: 25–30% of order value.

3

Your Direct Ordering Page — Build It on Lovable

A simple website with your menu, photos, ordering form, and payment link is the most valuable asset in your ghost kitchen business. Every customer who orders directly instead of through a platform saves you 25–30% in commission. Build your direct ordering page fast at caribstream.io/lovable — describe what you want and it builds a professional ordering page in minutes. No coding required. Promote your direct link on every platform order with a card in every delivery bag offering 10% off direct orders.

Menu Item	Price	Food Cost	Margin
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Jerk chicken plate	\$18	\$5	\$13 (72%)
Curry goat plate	\$22	\$7	\$15 (68%)
Oxtail plate	\$26	\$9	\$17 (65%)
Fried plantains (side)	\$6	\$1.50	\$4.50 (75%)
Doubles / roti	\$8	\$2	\$6 (75%)

Building Your Direct Ordering Channel

Every direct order saves you 25%. Here is how to build the channel.

Platform orders fund your operation. Direct orders fund your growth. The goal is to convert as many platform customers as possible to direct ordering over time. Every customer who shifts from DoorDash to your direct page increases your margin from 65–70% to 90%+ on the same order. Your direct channel is your most profitable business asset.

1**The In-Bag Card — Your Most Effective Marketing Tool**

Print 500 cards (\$30) that say: 'Thank you for ordering [Your Brand]. Order directly at [your website] and get 10% off your next order. No app needed. Pay by card, Apple Pay, or Zelle.' Include this card in every single delivery bag. At a 20% conversion rate from platform to direct on 20 daily orders: 4 new direct customers per day.

2**WhatsApp Order Channel — The Caribbean Standard**

Caribbean customers trust WhatsApp. A WhatsApp Business account allows customers to text their order directly — name, address, items, and payment via Zelle or CashApp. No platform fees. No commission. Your WhatsApp direct channel is especially powerful with Caribbean church communities and your social media followers who become weekly ordering customers.

3**Weekly Meal Prep Subscriptions**

Offer a weekly subscription: 5 family meals for \$95/week delivered every Sunday. Caribbean families who subscribe pay in advance via Zelle, pick from your rotating weekly menu, and receive consistent home delivery. 10 subscription families at \$95/week = \$950/week in guaranteed pre-paid revenue before you cook a single meal.

4

Catering as Your Highest Margin Channel

Caribbean community events — birthdays, church dinners, cultural gatherings, Carnival parties — need Caribbean food catering. A catering booking for 50 people at \$25/head = \$1,250 from one event. Your food cost on a catering order is 25–30% versus 35–40% on individual delivery orders because you cook in bulk with better yield. Two catering bookings per month add \$2,500 in high-margin revenue to your base.

YOUR BUSINESS WEBSITE — PERSONAL NOTE

A professional booking page — showing your services, pricing, and availability — converts clients who find you online into booked jobs without a single cold call. I found it significantly easier to use Lovable — an AI site builder where you describe what you want and it builds a professional site in minutes. No coding required. caribstream.io/lovable

Marketing Your Caribbean Ghost Kitchen

Social media, community marketing, and content that builds a loyal customer base.

Caribbean food markets itself when the content is right. A 30-second video of jerk chicken coming off the grill, sauce glistening, with the right music and a link to your ordering page generates more orders than any paid advertisement. Your marketing strategy is content-first, community-first, and platform-second.

1**TikTok and Instagram Reels — Your Primary Channel**

Film 60-second cooking videos: the prep, the seasoning, the cooking, the plating, the packaging. Caribbean cooking content performs exceptionally well on TikTok — the visual drama of jerk chicken, the steam rising from oxtail, the bright colors of Caribbean vegetables generate millions of views organically. Post 3 times per week minimum.

2**Caribbean Facebook Groups — Direct Community Marketing**

Post in Caribbean community groups with your weekly menu and a direct ordering link. 'This Sunday: jerk chicken plates, curry goat, oxtail, and fried plantains. Order by Saturday night for Sunday delivery. Direct orders at [your website] — link in bio.' Caribbean community groups have thousands of members actively looking for exactly this food.

3**Caribbean Church and Community Event Sampling**

Bring sample portions to Caribbean church events, cultural gatherings, and community meetings. Sampling at a Caribbean event with 100 attendees generates 15–25 first-time orders in the following week. Every sample you give is a marketing investment with a documented 15–25% conversion rate.

YOUR BRAND NAMING PRINCIPLE

Your ghost kitchen name should communicate Caribbean identity and quality immediately. Examples: Island Kitchen [City] · Caribbean Table · The Yard Kitchen · Roots Caribbean Eats. Avoid generic food names that do not signal your cultural identity. The name is what the customer searches for the second time they order. Make it memorable, make it Caribbean, make it yours.

Scaling — From Weekend Kitchen to Full Operation

Second brand, additional kitchen time, and catering that multiplies revenue.

The ghost kitchen scales through increased kitchen hours, a second menu brand operating from the same kitchen, and catering expansion. You do not need a second location to double your revenue — you need a second brand targeting a different cuisine segment, more kitchen time, and a catering team.

1

Second Menu Brand — Same Kitchen, Different Cuisine

A second ghost kitchen brand operating under the same kitchen time and business entity targets a different cuisine or price point. Your Caribbean brand does jerk and oxtail. Your second brand does Caribbean-influenced burgers or wraps for the lunch crowd. Same ingredients, different presentation, different platform listing, different customer. Revenue from two brands in the same kitchen time block: 60–80% more than one brand alone.

2

Hiring a Prep Cook

At 25+ orders per day, cooking and managing orders simultaneously becomes unsustainable. A part-time prep cook (\$15–\$18/hour for 4-hour prep sessions) handles ingredient preparation while you focus on cooking and quality control. Cost per session: \$60–\$72. Revenue protected by consistent quality and faster fulfillment: \$400–\$600 per session.

3

Catering Team Expansion

A regular catering assistant paid \$18–\$22/hour for event days allows you to take larger catering bookings — 100+ person events at \$25–\$35/head — that generate \$2,500–\$3,500 per event. Two catering events per month plus your daily delivery operation = \$5,000–\$7,000 in additional monthly revenue from the catering channel alone.

Revenue Stream	Volume	Monthly Revenue
Platform orders (net of 25% fee)	20 orders/day @ \$20 avg	\$9,000
Direct orders (no fee)	10 orders/day @ \$20 avg	\$6,000
Weekly meal subscriptions	15 families @ \$95/wk	\$5,700

Catering events	2 events/month @ \$3,000	\$6,000
TOTAL		\$26,700/month

CARIBBEAN EARNER PRINCIPLE

Grenada is known as the Spice Isle — the world's second-largest producer of nutmeg, grown from a single seed introduced centuries ago. One seed. One decision to plant. Your ghost kitchen starts the same way — one kitchen session, one menu, one community that is hungry for what you cook.

Cook Caribbean. Build a Brand. Deliver Everywhere.

Your community is ordering Caribbean food from generic delivery apps because your ghost kitchen does not exist yet. The kitchen is available. The platforms are ready. The Caribbean community in your city is hungry for what you cook. The only missing ingredient is your decision to start.

YOUR FIRST 30-DAY ACTION PLAN

Week 1 — Kitchen and certification

Get your food handler's certification online. Contact 3 Caribbean churches about kitchen rental. Set up your DoorDash and Uber Eats merchant accounts.

Week 2 — Menu and direct ordering page

Finalize your 6-item menu. Cook each dish and photograph it professionally. Build your direct ordering page at caribstream.io/lovable.

Week 3 — First orders

Go live on DoorDash and Uber Eats. Post your menu in Caribbean Facebook groups. Accept your first direct orders via WhatsApp. Target 10 orders your first weekend.

Week 4 — Build toward 20 orders/day

Post cooking content on TikTok and Instagram 3x per week. Sample at one Caribbean community event. Convert 3 platform customers to direct ordering.

KEY RESOURCES AND AFFILIATE LINKS

Direct ordering page (affiliate) — caribstream.io/lovable DoorDash Merchant — merchant.doordash.com Uber Eats Restaurant — restaurant.uber.com Commissary kitchen finder — kitch.en ServSafe food handler certification — servsafe.com Food packaging supplier — webstaurantstore.com

REAL SKILLS. REAL INCOME. NO HYPE.

CaribStream.io

Caribbean adults abroad. Building wealth. Keeping roots.

